CALIFORNIA · HOME CARE ORGANIZATION (HCO) LICENSE

California Home Care License Readiness Checklist

Everything the California Department of Social Services — Home Care Services Branch will expect to find in place before it licenses a non-medical home care agency under Health & Safety Code Division 2, Chapter 13 and CDSS HCS forms/PINs — in one page, so you can tick it off before you apply and before any inspection. From AutoloomStudio, the makers of the California policy and procedure manual.

Before you apply — and before any inspection

- [ ] Entity formed with the B1 documents in hand — Partnership Agreement or sealed/stamped Articles ...
- [ ] The California office fixed, with all pertinent records held there and the out-of-state and Secretary of State rules of ...
- [ ] The owner, every 10%-or-greater owner and the CEO identified for the background examination ...
- [ ] The HCS 308 designee named (not the licensee itself) with the Board Resolution where required ...
- [ ] The employee dishonesty bond on HCS 402 obtained — $10,000 minimum including third-party coverage ...
- [ ] The $1,000,000 per occurrence / $3,000,000 aggregate general and professional liability certificate and the workers' ...
- [ ] This manual adopted and Exhibit A printed under its cover sheet, with the Section B documents generated from it ...
- [ ] The B4 training plan naming the trainer, written objectives and the title and duration of both tiers ...
- [ ] The one-packet rule understood: all Section A forms with original signatures in booklet order, all Section B documents ...
- [ ] The Guardian agency account planned, the HCO PIN procedure understood ...
- [ ] The orientation budgeted ($50.00, non-refundable, virtual, not on demand) and the person who will attend identified
- [ ] The registry gate built into hiring: no affiliated home care aide has direct client contact before the registry shows ...
- [ ] The TB system ready: examinations 90 days before or within 7 days after employment, certificates filed ...
- [ ] The three reporting clocks posted where schedulers work: mandated abuse reports by the observing reporter to county APS ...
- [ ] The complaint route named in the client pack: the Agency's own process plus the CCLD Centralized Complaint and ...
- [ ] The posting plan ready: licence, business hours and any other required information conspicuous and visible to clients ...
- [ ] The compliance calendar loaded: licence expiry and the 60-day renewal notice window ...
- [ ] HCS 9201 requested from CDSS and aligned to it line by line when obtained [not read at edition date — verify]
- [ ] The renewal-process PINs 21-06-HCS and 22-03-HCS extracted and read before the first renewal [not read at edition date ...
- [ ] LIC 508's status confirmed with HCSB — in the HCS 281 booklet but not on the current Section A chart [verify]

Key contacts (verify at the time of use)

- CDSS Community Care Licensing Division, Home Care Services Branch (HCSB) — 744 P Street, M.S. 9-14-90, Sacramento, CA 95814; (877) 424-5778; HCSB@dss.ca.gov; clearance transfers also to FaxHCSB@dss.ca.gov
- Care Provider Management Branch (CPMB) — background checks and Guardian: 744 P Street, M.S. 19-60, Sacramento, CA 95814; 1-888-422-5669; guardian@dss.ca.gov; exemption transfers by fax (916) 754-4589
- Guardian — CDSS's online background-check and application portal: aide applications with the Agency's HCO PIN, pre-filled Live Scan forms, roster management, exemption submission and status monitoring
- Home Care Aide Registry public search — ccld.dss.ca.gov/hcsregistry/registrysearch.aspx (name and registration number; status, expiry and HCO association)
- Application pages and fees — cdss.ca.gov Home Care Services pages: the HCO application-process page, the Application Fees page ($5,603 HCO / $35 HCA / $100 location change / $200 corporation change, as displayed 4 Nov 2026) and the 8-step application guide PDF
- CCLD Complaint Hotline page — cdss.ca.gov/inforesources/ccld-complaint-hotline (complaints about an HCO run through the CCLD Centralized Complaint and Information Bureau — PIN 24-01-HCS); suspected abuse or fraud: cdss.ca.gov/complaints
- Official statute — leginfo.legislature.ca.gov: Health & Safety Code Division 2, Chapter 13 (§§ 1796.10–1796.70); re-read before every print run
- PIN subscriptions and listing — HCO updates eepurl.com/hvOJ9n; HCA updates eepurl.com/hvOKVX; the HCS-series PIN listing on the CDSS PINs page (latest held: PIN 26-02-HCS, 27 Mar 2026)

Ready to apply? Here is the next step.

42 policies | 50 forms | Editable Word + PDF

Every line on this checklist has a written policy and a form behind it in the California Home Care Organization Policy and Procedure Manual — Non-Medical Home Care Edition. Written to the text of Health & Safety Code Division 2, Chapter 13 and CDSS HCS forms/PINs with every policy cited and the rule's own words in each one, a crosswalk from every requirement to the page that meets it, the application guide, and a "what to watch" layer for the points the rule leaves open.

Your checklist offer: 20% off the manual with code CHECKLIST20 (US$59 → US$47.20). Click to get it with the code already applied:
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Or search Etsy for "AutoloomStudio California home care policy and procedure manual" and enter CHECKLIST20 at checkout. Valid until 11 May 2027.

This checklist is drawn from the published text of Health & Safety Code Division 2, Chapter 13 and CDSS HCS forms/PINs and the regulator's published application materials as of October 2026. It is a template, not legal advice, and it is not approved or endorsed by the California Department of Social Services — Home Care Services Branch. Rules, forms and fees change — check the regulator's page before you rely on any item. © 2026 AutoloomStudio. You may print and use this checklist for your own agency; please do not resell it.